

TV SHOW

Ozark Season 4 Part 2

★★★★☆ | Part 2 of season 4 of Ozark kicked off right where Part 1 left off. Ruth (played by Julia Garner) is in search of vengeance while the Byrdes try desperately to get a hold on the escalating situation involving Ruth and the Mexican drug cartel they have been laundering money for. Ozark has always been menacingly dark and gritty and it stayed true to its nature until the very end of the show. Tensions began escalating from the very start and in the first episode, we were served with a shocker that changed the course of the Byrdes' well laid-out plans and sent Navarro's (played by Felix Solis) cartel into overdrive. However, the second episode onwards, there was a period of lull that we've never really experienced with Ozark before. This lull



transmogrified into a flurry of events that felt like a bit of a rush job in the last two episodes. It seemed like the showrunners ran out of time and were attempting to wrap things up in a satisfying manner. We don't know about satisfying, but the finale was certainly honest. It convincingly portrayed the state of events that Wendy (played by Laura Linney) and Marty Byrde (played by Jason Bateman) had gotten themselves and their children into, not just for now, but for life. The last

two words uttered by Wendy in the show were truly chilling to hear, which is a testament to the excellent show put on by Laura Linney. She is the primary antagonist of the show; not some mafia leader, not some hitman, but her. A mother of two and a wife of a financial advisor who turned into a terrifying oligarch. While the acting and cinematography is top-notch, as always, in Ozark, the storyline lacks some believability. Marty and Wendy's son Noah (played by Skylar Gaertner), who was defiant and outrageous at his mother for the entire duration of the fourth season seemed to have an overnight change of heart and side with his family in a pressing circumstance, thereby saving the day and the Byrdes. The show simply didn't put in enough time or effort to make this feel like a natural move. So while we were content with the show's end, Season 4 Part 2 was definitely the weakest link in Ozark's journey as a show. It still doesn't deter us from recommending this show to anyone who enjoys mafia and cartel dramas.

—Dhriti Datta

TV SHOW

Moon Knight

★★★★☆ | The one thing that Marvel seems to love doing with Phase 4 'content' is to completely ignore the comics and come up with whatever's hip and cool and trendy. And sadly, Moon Knight is another casualty of that approach. If you've read any Moon Knight comics, then the show will make no sense to you as it does not follow any of the comic book lore. Moon Knight is essentially a bad-ass mercenary named Marc Spector who acts as the avatar of Khonshu, a minor Egyptian deity. The comics were full of action and brutal violence as Marc faced off against foes like the Bushman and other mercenaries with the crowning run being writer Warren Ellis' six-issue mini-series. Why the showrunners didn't use this version of the character is utterly baffling. The show centres around Steven Grant, a



'personality' of Marc Spector who has a corny British accent and works in a gift shop in a museum in London. Instead of a dark, tortured hero with serious issues, we get a slapstick-esque performance from Issac who is so miscast it's not funny. The director talks about

depicting mental illness in the show but this clearly isn't how people with borderline personality disorder act. It's an unfunny and frankly insulting way of depicting such serious issues. The plot of the show isn't any better as Steven wakes up in the Alps one morning after sleepwalking and is thrust into a tired old plot of cult leaders and world domination. Sure, you get a few action sequences here and there; it's all so heavily edited that you can barely make out what's going on. The show also stars Ethan Hawke as cult leader Arthur Harrow and he delivers a yawn-inducing performance. Look, if you're a Marvel consumer, you'll love this show as it hits all the beats that one could expect right down to the emasculation of its titular hero. As a fan of the comics, you'll have a hard time holding down your lunch after this travesty. This is a Disney product through and through and is a soulless piece of content that will be forgotten as soon as you turn off the television.

—Andrew Lu